Low-Code Experiment

Data Modelling and Form Design for a Business Application in Zoho Creator

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Abstract

This experiment designs the data model and form for a Hotel Room Booking application in Zoho Creator. A form named Room Booking Form was built using the thirteen basic field types, grouped into four sections, and a report was created to list the submitted booking requests. Field validations were applied and the form was tested by submitting sample bookings.

1. Aim

To design a Room Booking Form in Zoho Creator using the basic field types, apply field validations, and view the submitted booking requests in a report.

2. Introduction

A hotel that takes bookings through phone calls and messages has no structured record of its guests until they arrive. A single online form solves this by collecting the guest details, room preferences and arrival schedule in a fixed format. In Zoho Creator, each field on a form becomes a column of the data table, so designing the form is the same as designing the data model of the application.

The form in this experiment uses the thirteen basic fields: Name, Email, Address, Phone, Single Line, Multi Line, Number, Date, Time, Drop Down, Radio, Multi Select and Checkbox.

3. Form Design

The fields are organized into four sections so that the form is easy for a guest to follow.

Section	Field Name	Field Type	Purpose
A. Guest Details	Guest Name	Name	Full name of the guest (first and last name)
	ID Proof Number	Single Line	Identification document number
	Number Of Guests	Number	Total number of guests
B. Contact Details	Email Address	Email	Email for the booking confirmation
	Contact Number	Phone	Mobile number with country code
	Permanent Address	Address	Residential address for records
C. Room and Stay Preferences	Room Type	Drop Down	Choose one room category

Section	Field Name	Field Type	Purpose
	Meal Plan	Radio	Room Only, Breakfast Included or All Meals Included
	Amenities Required	Multi Select	One or more extra amenities
	Special Requests	Multi Line	Free-text remarks
D. Scheduling and Policy	Check In Date	Date	Intended check-in date
	Preferred Checkin Time	Time	Expected arrival time
	Agree To Hotel Policies	Checkbox	Acknowledgement of hotel policies

4. Procedure

Step 1: Create the form and add fields. Inside the HOTEL BOOKING application, a new form named Room Booking Form was created. The fields were dragged from the Basic Fields palette onto the form, and sections were used to group them. Figure 1 shows the Guest Details and Contact Details sections, and Figure 2 shows the Room and Stay Preferences and Scheduling and Policy sections.

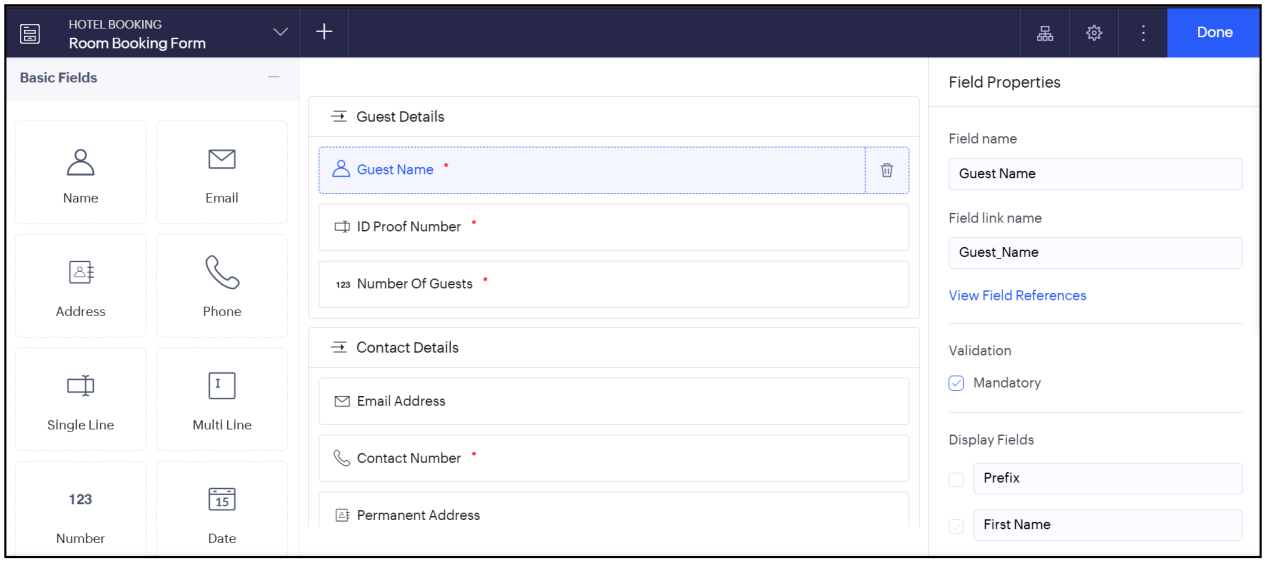


Figure 1: Form Builder: Guest Details and Contact Details sections

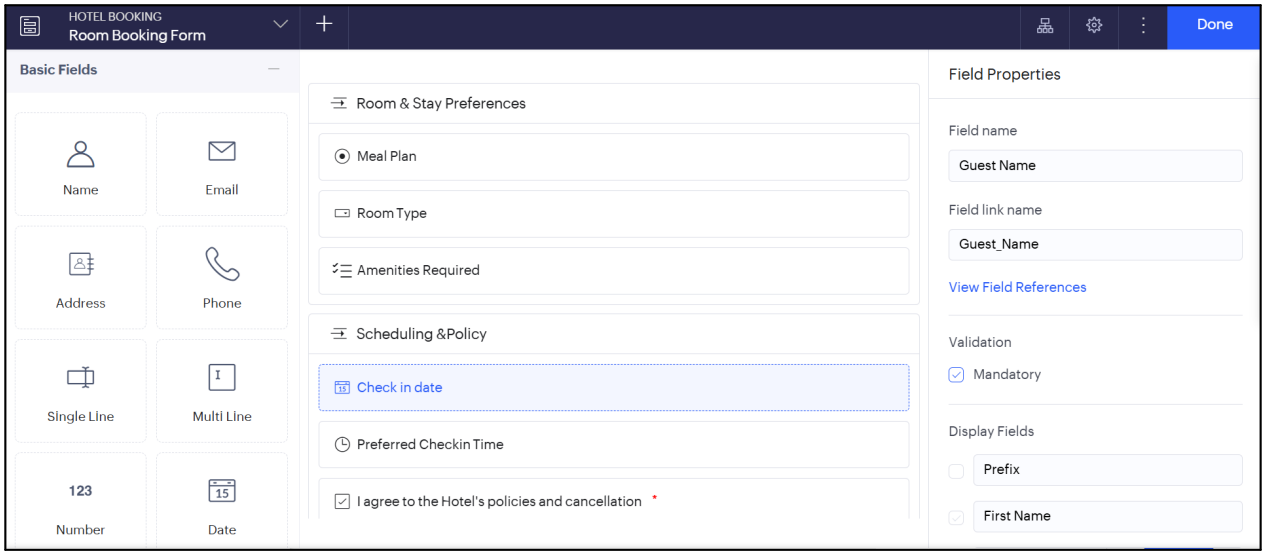


Figure 2: Form Builder: Room and Stay Preferences and Scheduling and Policy sections

Step 2: Set field properties and validations. For each field, the field name and link name were checked in the Field Properties panel, and the *Mandatory* option was ticked for the required fields. Required fields are marked with a red asterisk on the form. Figure 3 shows the properties of the Number Of Guests field.

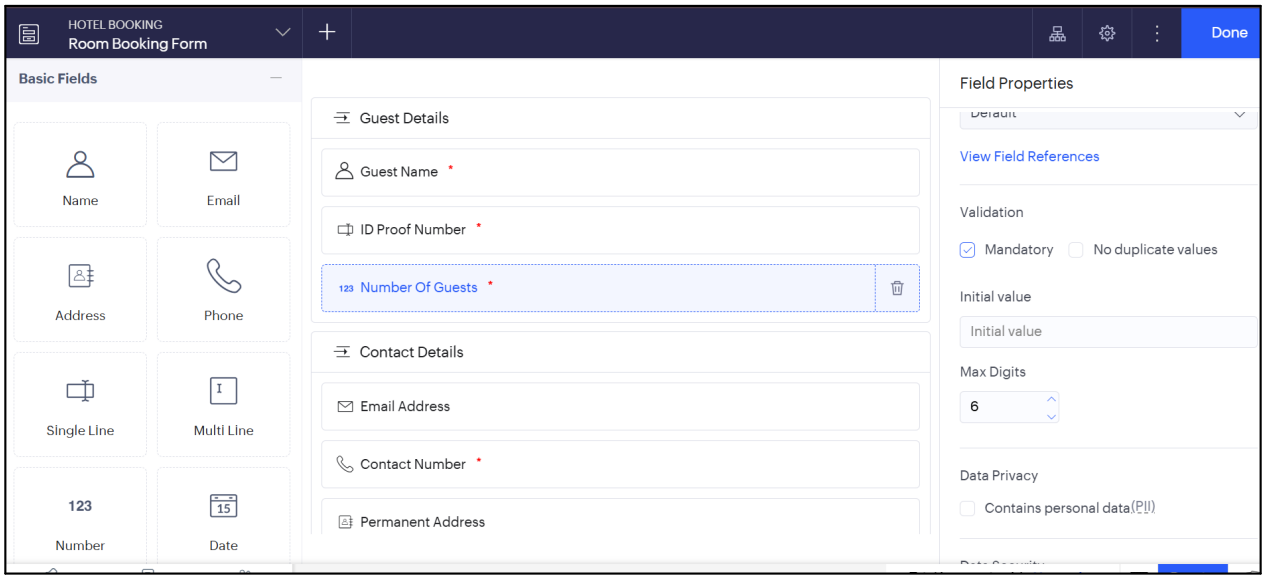


Figure 3: Field Properties of the Number Of Guests field

Step 3: Preview the form. The form was opened using Access Development Live. The Contact Number field shows the India (+91) country code format (Figure 4).

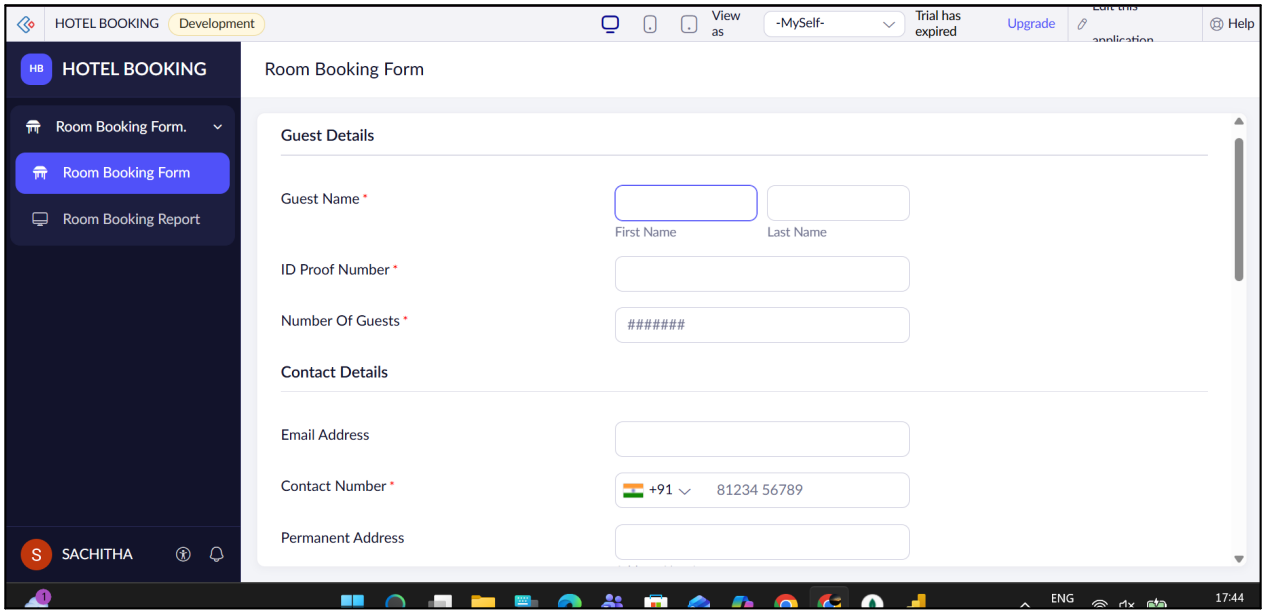


Figure 4: Live form opened in the browser

Step 4: Test the validation. The form was submitted with required fields left empty. Zoho Creator blocked the submission, showed the message *Invalid entries found*, and marked the empty fields with the message *This field is mandatory. Enter a value.* (Figure 5).

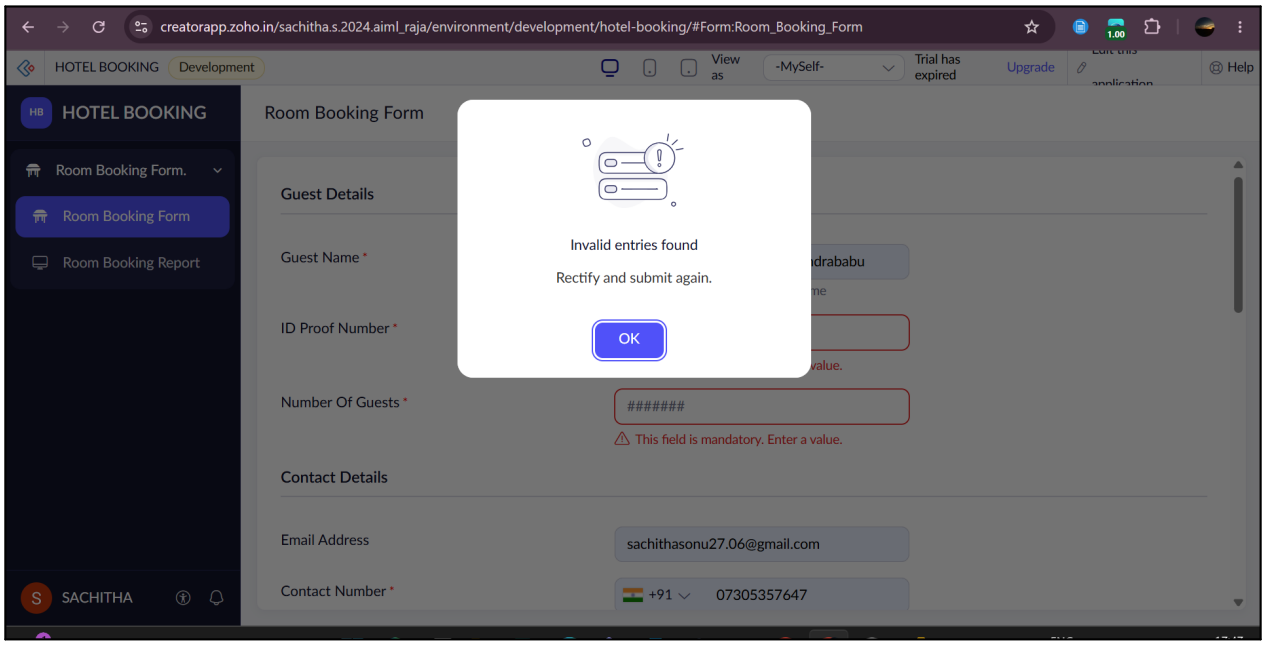
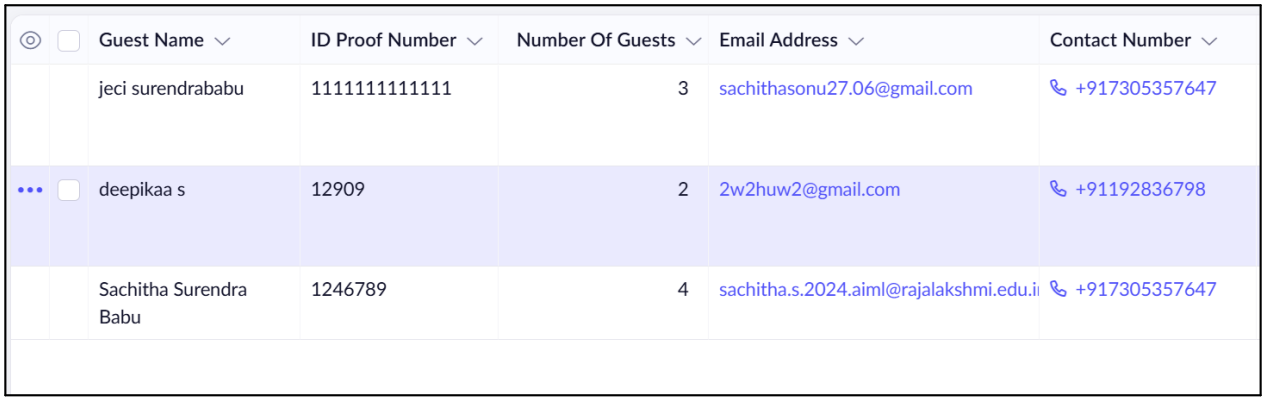


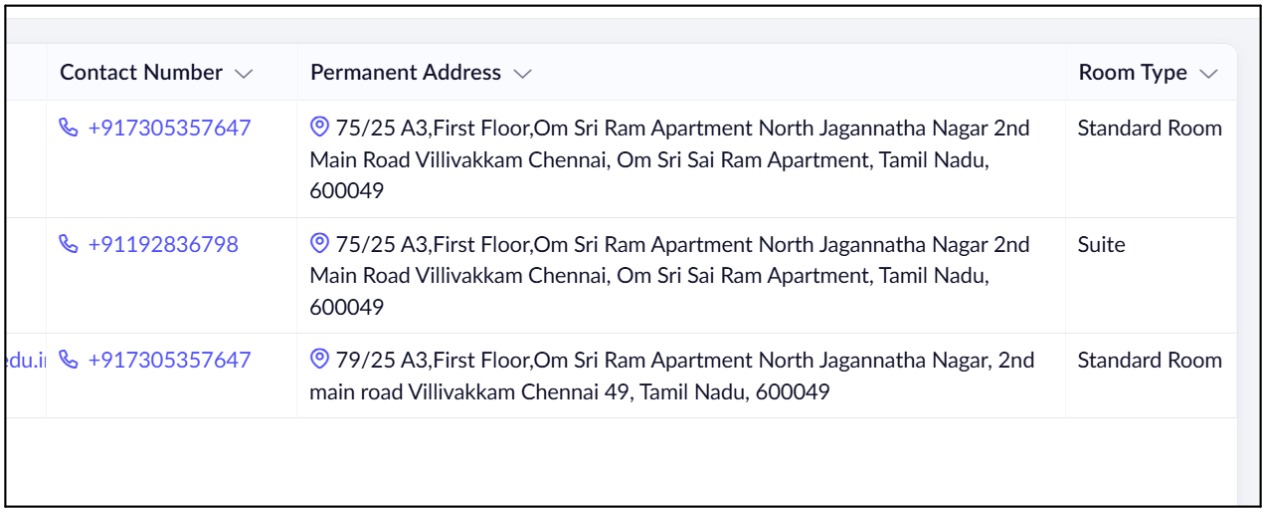
Figure 5: Mandatory field validation message on submit

Step 5: Submit sample bookings and view the report. Three sample booking requests were submitted. The report named Room Booking Report lists each submission as a row, with one column for each form field (Figures 6 and 7).



Guest Name	ID Proof Number	Number Of Guests	Email Address	Contact Number
jeci surendrababu	1111111111111	3	sachithasonu27.06@gmail.com	+917305357647
deepikaa s	12909	2	2w2huw2@gmail.com	+91192836798
Sachitha Surendra Babu	1246789	4	sachitha.s.2024.aiml@rajalakshmi.edu.i	+917305357647

Figure 6: Room Booking Report: guest and contact columns



Contact Number	Permanent Address	Room Type
+917305357647	75/25 A3,First Floor,Om Sri Ram Apartment North Jagannatha Nagar 2nd Main Road Villivakkam Chennai, Om Sri Sai Ram Apartment, Tamil Nadu, 600049	Standard Room
+91192836798	75/25 A3,First Floor,Om Sri Ram Apartment North Jagannatha Nagar 2nd Main Road Villivakkam Chennai, Om Sri Sai Ram Apartment, Tamil Nadu, 600049	Suite
+917305357647	79/25 A3,First Floor,Om Sri Ram Apartment North Jagannatha Nagar, 2nd main road Villivakkam Chennai 49, Tamil Nadu, 600049	Standard Room

Figure 7: Room Booking Report: address and room type columns

5. Validations Applied

Field	Validation
Guest Name, ID Proof Number, Number Of Guests, Contact Number	Mandatory
Agree To Hotel Policies	Mandatory, so the form cannot be submitted unless it is ticked
Email Address	Built-in email format check of the Email field type
Contact Number	Phone field with the India (+91) country code

6. Result

The Room Booking Form was built with the basic field types, tested with sample data, and the submitted bookings appear in the Room Booking Report.

7. Conclusion

A form in Zoho Creator is both the data entry screen and the data model of the application. Choosing the right field type for each piece of information gives built-in validation and a clean report with no extra coding.

8. Learning Outcome

This experiment gives practice in choosing field types, grouping fields into sections, applying mandatory validations, and viewing form data in a report.